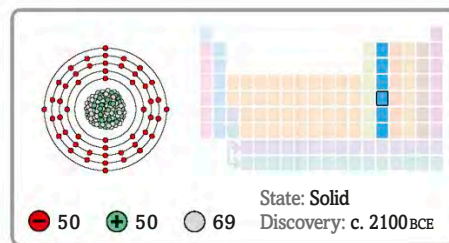


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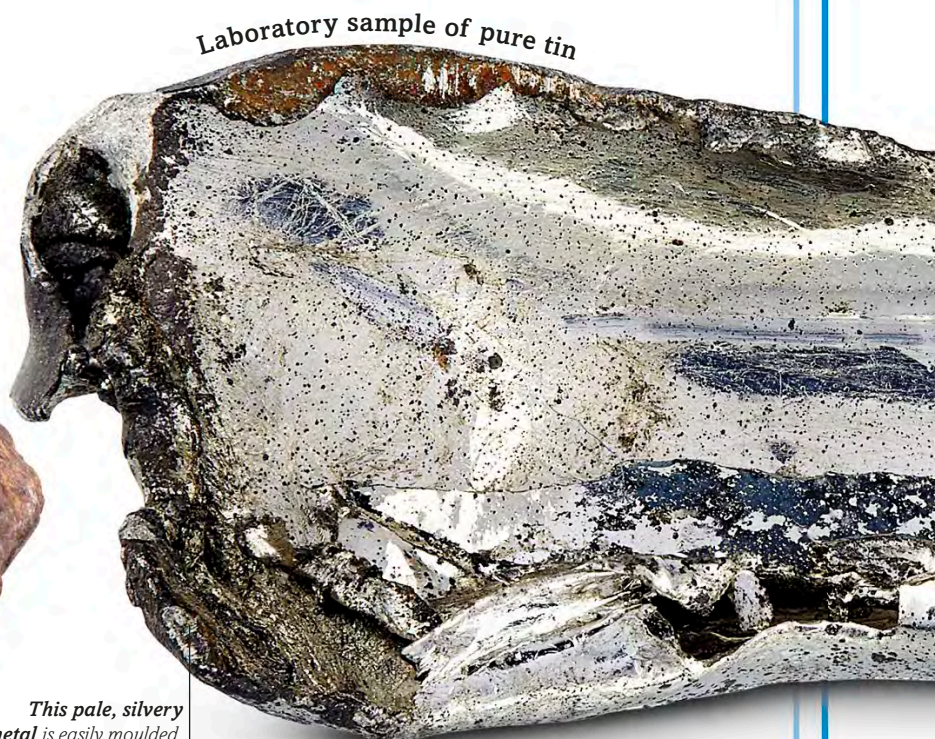
Tin



Forms



The black colour of the crystals is due to iron impurities.



This pale, silvery metal is easily moulded.

Uses



Tin plating over steel makes the can more resistant to corrosion.



This shiny alloy contains around 90% tin.



The tin plating on this steel whistle prevents rusting.



The large pipes of this organ are made of tin and lead.

Tin was one of the first metals used by humans. As long as 5,000 years ago, tin was mixed with copper to make bronze, an alloy that was stronger than either pure metal. The ore **cassiterite** is the main source of **pure tin**. Uses for tin are many, including

plating steel objects, such as **cans**, to stop them corroding. A compound called tin chloride is used for dyeing silks. This metal continues to be used in a variety of tough alloys, including **pewter**, soft solder, and bronze.